

**START-UP PLAN FOR ZZZPACE:
A DIGITAL APPLICATION FOR STUDENTS
IN CENTRAL MINDANAO UNIVERSITY**

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Zzzpace is a mobile-based digital housing marketplace created in order to simplify and improve Central Mindanao University (CMU) students' dorm and boarding house search. The platform addresses common challenges that students experience, including disorganized information throughout social media, hidden costs, unreliable listings, and time-consuming physical visits. Zzzpace converts traditional and ineffective home search process into a quicker, more transparent, and easier digital experience by providing a centrally organized, user-friendly application.

Zzzpace's main target market would be the CMU students, especially those between the ages of 18 and 25 who are tech-savvy, mobile-dependent, and budget-conscious. Local landlords and dorm owners, who'll gain from more visibility, quicker tenant securing, and more effective property management, represent the platform's secondary market. Zzzpace establishes a balanced sustainability that satisfies housing supply and demand by connecting these two groups together. Additionally, what make Zzzpace important in the market is its primary features, which directly address user needs, these include realtime availability updates to avoid unnecessary questions, verified listings with real images to verify legitimacy, and real-time pricing transparency to remove hidden costs. Additionally, this platform offers complex filtering options based on student interests, like proximity to university, study spaces, and Wi-Fi connectivity, along with integrated digital payment methods for safe and easy transactions and secure in-app messaging between students and landlords. Referral bonuses and first-time user bonuses are examples of incentive-based features that increase user adoption and engagement.

Overall, Zzzpace is targets to create a significant positive impact on the CMU community. It fosters transparency and confidence in the rental market while lowering the stress, effort, and expense involved in locating student accommodation. In addition, it does not only help the students, but also helps landlords by increasing occupancy rates and offering effective digital tools for property marketing. Over time, Zzzpace positions itself as a crucial platform for campus living and helps create a more structured, easily accessible, and student-centered housing system.

I. VALUE PROPOSITION

Imagine finding a dorm near Central Mindanao University should be an exciting part of preparing for college life, yet for many students, it becomes a stressful and exhausting experience. Instead of quickly finding a place to stay, students often spend hours scrolling through crowded Facebook groups filled with incomplete information, hidden prices, and unanswered inquiries, while others are forced to walk around Musuan just to check available rooms—only to discover that some are already occupied or do not match what was advertised. This outdated process wastes time, money, and energy for both students and their families. Zzzspace transforms this frustrating experience by providing a centralized digital marketplace where CMU students can easily browse verified listings, compare prices, check amenities, communicate with landlords, and secure housing through their smartphones, making the search for a safe, affordable, and comfortable home faster, easier, and more convenient.

To provide a better and more efficient product, we identified common housing problems and created solutions based on recent studies. One major problem is housing affordability and accessibility. According to Sabah, F. Y. (2025), affordable housing remains a global challenge due to rising rental costs and limited housing supply, making it difficult for students and low-income renters to find suitable accommodations. Their study emphasized that digital housing systems can help improve accessibility and housing allocation.

Another challenge is the growing dependence of Generation Z on mobile applications for everyday transactions. Shetu (2025) found that Gen Z consumers prefer mobile applications because they offer greater convenience, accessibility, and faster transactions, showing the increasing demand for digital platforms that can simplify traditional processes such as searching for student housing. Trust is also a major factor in online accommodation platforms, as Perez-Aranda et al. (2024) emphasized that users often rely on verified information, online reviews, and platform reputation when making accommodation decisions. Without verified listings and clear communication channels, users may hesitate to trust online rental platforms. In addition, pricing transparency remains a significant concern among young consumers. Secretaria et al. (2023) revealed that Generation Z consumers are more likely to trust platforms that openly display prices rather than hiding fees, which directly addresses the common “PM for price” issue students often encounter when looking for boarding houses.

Digital payment systems also continue to grow among younger consumers. According to Silanoi et al. (2023), Generation Z users show increasing confidence in mobile banking platforms because they offer convenience, speed, and transaction security. This supports Zzzpace's secure payment integration feature.

To solve these problems, we propose the creation of Zzzpace, a digital housing marketplace specifically designed for CMU students.

Zzzpace aims to:

1. Provide real-time pricing transparency for rental fees and deposits.
2. Offer verified room photos to reduce unnecessary ocular visits.
3. Show real-time room availability updates.
4. Allow filtering based on Wi-Fi, study spaces, cooking allowance, and proximity to colleges.
5. Provide secure in-app communication between students and landlords.
6. Integrate secure digital payment systems such as GCash.
7. Offer referral rewards and first-time user bonuses.
8. Include an emergency hotline feature to provide immediate access to assistance during urgent situations, thereby enhancing user safety.
9. Implement a scam protection system that detects suspicious listings and verifies landlords to prevent fraudulent activities and strengthen user trust.

Unlike traditional platforms such as Facebook, Facebook Messenger, and Google Maps, Zzzpace combines housing search, pricing transparency, communication, booking, and payments into one platform specifically designed for student housing needs. Through this innovation, Zzzpace helps students save time, reduce stress, avoid unnecessary transportation costs, and make smarter housing decisions while helping landlords increase visibility and occupancy rates. It also supports local businesses and improves the housing experience of the entire CMU community.

II. DESCRIPTION

Zzzpace is a mobile based marketplace that helps students of Central Mindanao University find a place to stay. This platform makes it easy for students to look for dormitories or boarding houses. Usually, students face a lot of problems when they are looking for a place to stay. They have to deal with information they do not know what they are getting and they have to visit a lot of places.

Zzzpace is different. It is like a one stop shop where students can look at all the housing options on their smartphones. The application has a lot of features that make things easy for students. For example, students can see the prices of the rooms in time so they know exactly how much they have to pay. They can also see pictures of the rooms so they know what they are getting. They can even filter their search based on what they want like Wi-Fi or a place to study.

The platform also has a messaging system so students can talk to landlords directly and safely. They do not have to give out their personal contact information. When they find a place, they like they can pay for it using the app. This way they have a record of all their transactions.

Zzzpace also helps students save money. If they refer a friend to the platform they get a reward. If they use the platform for the first time they get a bonus. This helps students pay for their housing. At the time it helps landlords because they can advertise their properties more easily.

System Flow Overview:

1. **User Registration/Login** – Students create an account or log in to access the platform.
2. **Search & Filter** – Users browse listings and apply filters based on preferences.
3. **View Details** – Users check room information, pricing, and photos.
4. **Communication** – Students contact landlords through the in-app messaging system.
5. **Booking & Payment** – Users reserve a room and complete payment within the app.
6. **Confirmation & Record Keeping** – Transactions are recorded for both students and landlords.

Thus, Zzzpace is not just an app for finding a place to stay. It is a solution that makes things easier and more transparent, for students and property owners. It connects students with landlords. It uses technology to make things more convenient. Zzzpace is a mobile based marketplace that helps students of Central

Mindanao University find a place to stay and it does a lot of other things to make their lives easier.

II. UNIQUENESS

Zzzpace is unique because it is made especially for students of Central Mindanao University. Unlike other platforms where information is messy or incomplete, Zzzpace shows clear and verified details. Students can see the real price, actual photos, and updated room availability. This helps them avoid confusion and saves time because they do not need to visit many places just to check if the information is true.

Another thing that makes Zzzpace different is that everything is in one app. Students do not need to switch between apps like Facebook or Messenger. They can search for rooms, talk to landlords, and pay all in one place. This makes the process faster, easier, and more convenient, especially for students who are used to using their phones for everything.

Zzzpace also focuses on safety and honesty. The app shows the full price with no hidden fees, and students can message landlords without sharing personal contact details. Payments are done inside the app, so there is a record of every transaction. This helps students feel more secure and confident when choosing a place to stay.

Lastly, Zzzpace gives extra benefits to users. Students can earn rewards by inviting their friends and get bonuses when they use the app for the first time. This helps them save money. At the same time, landlords can reach more students and fill their rooms faster. Because of this, Zzzpace helps both students and landlords in a simple and helpful way.

Zzzpace provides a more structured and trustworthy experience as compared to alternative home search options including Facebook groups, Marketplace listing, and word-of-mouth referrals. Many of the current possibilities frequently have out-of-date posts, little information, or slow replies from landlords. In order to verify availability, compare pricing, and ask inquiries, students might also need to use multiple apps. Zzzpace, on the other hand, combines all functions into a single platform with secure payment record, direct communication, and verified information. As a result, students at Central Mindanao University will find Zzzpace more reliable, convenient, and appropriate for their needs.

III. CUSTOMER UNDERSTANDING AND MARKETING

Zzzpace focuses on a clearly defined group of users to ensure that the service is effective and relevant. The primary target market consists of Central Mindanao University (CMU) students, particularly those aged 18 to 25 years old. These students are typically tech-savvy, frequently use smartphones, and are budget-conscious, making them ideal users of a digital housing platform. In addition, the secondary market includes dorm owners and landlords located near CMU. These individuals seek faster occupancy rates and more efficient ways to manage tenants, which Zzzpace can provide through its system.

In line with this, there is a strong and consistent demand for student housing within the CMU community. With thousands of enrolled students every academic year, a significant portion come from outside the locality and nearby provinces, making daily commuting impractical. It is estimated that around 40% to 60% of students require boarding houses, dormitories, or shared accommodations, especially during regular semesters and peak academic periods. This means that several thousand students are actively searching for suitable housing at any given time. However, the available housing options are often fragmented, unverified, and insufficient to meet this growing demand, creating a clear gap in the market that Zzzpace aims to address.

Moreover, understanding customer needs is essential in designing a useful platform. Students primarily look for affordable housing that is safe, accessible, and close to campus. They also prefer having clear and complete information, such as pricing, amenities, and room conditions, before making decisions. However, many students currently face challenges such as unclear pricing due to the “PM is the key” culture, slow responses from landlords, and misleading or outdated listings. Furthermore, searching for housing can be time-consuming and physically exhausting when done through traditional methods. In terms of behavior, students are highly active on mobile apps and social media, rely on peer recommendations, and value convenience and speed when making decisions.

As a result, Zzzpace offers a strong value proposition by providing a fast, transparent, and student-friendly housing platform. It eliminates common frustrations by offering real-time pricing, verified listings with photos, and easy-to-use filters that match student preferences. Additionally, the platform enables direct communication with landlords and supports secure in-app payments, ensuring a safer and more

convenient experience. Not only that, but the reward system also allows students to save money through referrals and bonuses. Overall, Zzzpace helps students save time, reduce stress, and find suitable housing more efficiently.

To effectively reach its target market, Zzzpace will implement a combination of digital and on-ground marketing strategies. Firstly, digital marketing will play a major role by utilizing platforms such as Facebook, TikTok, and Instagram to promote the app, share user testimonials, and post engaging content. Secondly, a referral system will encourage users to invite friends in exchange for rewards such as discounts or points, thereby increasing user growth through peer influence. In addition, campus-based promotions such as posters, flyers, and booths during school events will help raise awareness among students. Lastly, partnerships with dorm owners, student influencers, and possibly CMU offices will strengthen credibility and expand reach.

In terms of branding, Zzzpace aims to establish itself as a modern, reliable, and student friendly platform. The brand name itself suggests comfort and rest, which aligns with the idea of finding a home. Furthermore, the tone of communication will be simple, helpful, and relatable to connect effectively with students. This approach ensures that users perceive Zzzpace as both professional and easy to use.

Equally important is maintaining strong relationships with customers. Zzzpace will focus on providing fast and responsive customer support to address user concerns. At the same time, ensuring that listings are accurate and verified will help build trust among users. Additionally, implementing a ratings and reviews system allows students to share their experiences, which can guide future users. To encourage loyalty, the platform will also offer rewards and incentives for repeat usage, ultimately turning first-time users into long-term customers.

Consequently, Zzzpace positions itself as the most convenient and trusted housing platform for CMU students. Compared to traditional methods such as Facebook groups, which are often unorganized and unreliable, Zzzpace provides a structured and efficient solution. This clear positioning highlights the platform's advantage in terms of convenience, transparency, and reliability.

Finally, the implementation of Zzzpace is expected to create a positive impact on students. By simplifying the housing search process, students will experience less stress and save significant time and effort. Moreover, access to accurate information will allow them to make better decisions, while the availability of more options can lead to more affordable housing choices. In the long run, Zzzpace contributes to a more efficient and student-centered housing system.

V. OPERATION PLAN

For both students and landlords, Zzzpace's everyday operations are planned to provide a seamless, effective, and stable experience. Users can access housing information at any time and from any location as a result of the system's continuous operation as a mobile-based digital platform. The core functions of this are the platform management, user interaction, listing verification, transaction processing, and customer support.

The system automatically maintains and updates real-time housing listings every day. Landlords can update room availability, upload images, change pricing, and display new listings by logging into their accounts. Students always view accurate and up-to-date items because these updates are immediately reflected on the platform. Recently uploaded listings go through a verification procedure where the system and administrators check aspects like photographs, pricing transparency, and information completeness before approving them in order to ensure quality and credibility.

For student users, the daily operation revolves around searching, filtering, and selecting housing options. Students may explore offers on the platform, set filters based on their interests (such location, amenities, and budget), and see thorough descriptions and photos. Through the real-time in-app messaging system, which secures users' private contact information, students may also speak with landlords directly. This eliminates the need for outside platforms and ensures convenient and secure communication. Another important daily function is transaction management. After choosing a housing option, students can use the built-in digital payment system (such as GCash) to make reservations or pay. The system securely handles payments and keeps track of every transaction, giving landlords and students a transparent transaction history. This lowers the possibility of fraud and makes sure both parties' accountability. Daily operations also include customer support and system monitoring. In order detect errors, fix technological problems, and address user concerns, the Zzzpace team routinely keeps an eye on platform activities. In order to enhance system performance and user experience, user feedback is regularly reviewed. Additionally, students can share their experiences through the platform's ratings and review system, which helps future users make better selections and motivates landlords to continue providing high-quality services.

The system depends on cloud-based infrastructure that allows data storage, security, and flexibility in order to provide consistent performance. To protect user

data and ensure strict adherence to the Data Privacy Act of 2012, regular maintenance, upgrades, and security audits are conducted out.

Overall, Zzzpace's everyday activities are focused on delivering reliable information, safe transactions, fast communication, and trustworthy system performance. By maintaining these procedures, the platform guarantees its users a smooth and reliable housing experience.

VI. COSTING, REVENUE, AND TIMELINE

A. Costing & Expenses Breakdown

The initial capital for Zzzpace is allocated toward developing a high-tech digital marketplace that replaces physical canvassing. The budget prioritizes system reliability and secure data handling to comply with the Data Privacy Act of 2012.

Category	Item Description	Estimated Cost	Subtotal
I. App Development	MVP Development & Google Maps API Integration	₱90,000	
	In-App Purchases Engine & Escrow Integration (Scam Protection)	₱35,000	
	B2B Merchant Dashboard (Ads & Paid Partnership Plugs)	₱15,000	
	Beta Testing & Security Audit	₱10,000	₱150,000
II. Marketing & Launch	Campus Ambassador Honorariums	₱6,000	
	Physical Signage (Tarps/Posters)	₱4,000	
	Social Media Ad Campaigns (Targeted)	₱5,000	
	Launch Event (Booth & Materials)	₱5,000	₱20,000
III. Acquisition Fund	Referral Rewards (₱50 x 300 users)	₱15,000	
	"Zzzpace Haul" First-Move Voucher	₱15,000	₱30,000
IV. Legal & Compliance			
	DTI & LGU Business Permits	₱8,500	
	Data Privacy Act (DPA) Compliance	₱4,500	

1. Risk Analysis

Risk	Impact	Mitigation Strategy
Data Breach/Privacy Leak	High: Loss of user trust and legal penalties under DPA 2012.	Implementation of end-to-end encryption and regular security audits by third-party experts.
Low Landlord Adoption	Medium: Limited listings reduce app value for students.	Launching a "Basic Free Tier" and providing on-ground assistance for digital onboarding.
System Downtime	High: Interrupts reservations and payments during peak enrollment.	Utilizing scalable cloud infrastructure (AWS/Google Cloud) with 99.9% uptime guarantees.

B. Revenue Model

Zzzpace generates revenue by providing visibility to landlords and convenience to students, solving the "Transparency Gap" in the Musuan housing market.

1. Revenue Measurement: Landlord Subscription Tiers

Instead of one-time fees, Zzzpace uses a **SaaS (“Software as a Service”)** model for landlords. This provides a predictable monthly income for the startup.

Tier	Target User	Monthly Fee (PHP)	Key Features
Basic	Starting Housing Units	Free	3 Listings/day, Standard Filtering
Premium	Mid-size Housing Units	₱499/mo	Unlimited Listings, "Zzzpace Verified" Badge & Top Search

Enterprise	Large Housing Complexes	₱1,200/mo	Unlimited/Bulk Listings, "Zzzpace Verified" Badge, Top Search, & Student Demand Analytics
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2. Revenue Justification

The subscription model targets the ~500+ boarding houses in the Musuan/Dologon area. By capturing just 20% of the market (approx. 100 landlords) on the Premium tier, the startup secures a stable baseline of ₱49,900 per month, covering operational overhead and server costs.

3. Break-Even Analysis (Year 1 Projection)

Metric	Value
Total Start-up Capital	₱218,500
Avg. Monthly Revenue	₱65,000 (Subscriptions + In-App Purchases)
Avg. Monthly OPEX	₱15,000 (Maintenance & Marketing)
Net Monthly Profit	₱50,000
Time to Recover ROI	4.3 Months post-launch

4. In-App Purchases

Feature	Description	Price (PHP)
PrioritieZ	Instant 5-day room freeze and guaranteed priority status for any chosen reservation.	₱199/use
Flash VacanZ	Immediate notification to students looking for vacancies in occupied rooms/units.	₱100/mo

5. Advertising & Paid Partnerships

Partner Type	Ad Format	Monthly Rate (PHP)
Local Services	Banners for laundry, water delivery, and moving (Pakyaw) help.	₱2,000
Study & Tech Hubs	Sponsored placements for local printing shops, study cafes, and laptop repair centers.	₱3,500

6. Affiliate Marketing

- Local Logistics Integration (Moving Help): Partnering with the CMU Tricycle Operators and Drivers Association (CMU-TODA) to provide a vetted pool of drivers for moving days, ensuring student safety and fair "Pakyaw" rates.
- Essential Service Bundles (Water & Laundry): Generates a 5-10% service commission per bundle sold, offering students a 15% bulk discount compared to individual walk-in rates.

7. Sponsorship and Collaboration

- Institutional Backing (SSC): Collaborating with the CMU Supreme Student Council to promote these services as "verified and safe" options for freshmen and out-of-town students.
- CMU Alumni Association: Engaging the association as a key potential sponsor to provide mentorship grants for technical security audits and fund "Alumni-Owned" trust badges for graduate-landlords.

C. Project Timeline (Gantt Chart)

Our 12-month strategic rollout (See Fig. 1) transitions Zzzspace from technical development to a fully integrated campus marketplace. By prioritizing institutional partnerships and secure transaction infrastructure early, we ensure a high-trust environment for Musuan students and local vendors from day one.

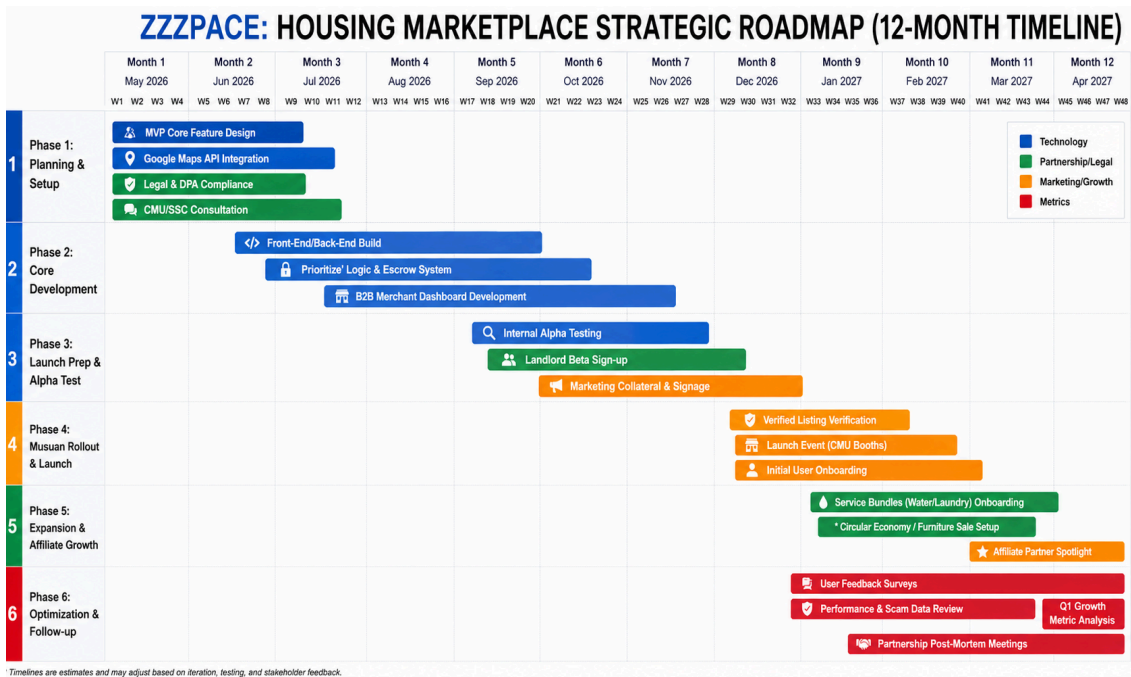


Fig. 1: Zzzspace Comprehensive Project Timeline

VII. DESCRIPTION AND RECOMMENDATION

A. Project Description

The development of Zzzpace, a mobile-based digital housing marketplace for students of Central Mindanao University, follows a structured 12-month timeline from May 2026 to April 2027. The project is divided into key phases, each with specific goals and outputs to ensure a systematic and efficient development process.

The project begins with the Planning and Research Phase (May–June 2026). This stage focuses on understanding the needs of CMU students and local landlords, as well as analyzing current housing search methods such as social media listings. The team will identify gaps in existing systems and define the core direction of the platform. The outputs for this phase includes project proposal, defined scope and objectives, user personas, market analysis report, and initial system requirements such as database structure and key features.

This is followed by the Design Phase (July–August 2026), where the visual and functional layout of the application is created. The team will develop wireframes and user interface designs that prioritize ease of use, accessibility, and responsiveness across devices. Initial prototypes will also be tested with selected users to gather feedback. Outputs include wireframes, UI/UX designs, user journey maps, and an interactive prototype.

Next is the Core Development Phase (September–December 2026), which involves building the main system of Zzzpace. Key features such as user accounts, real-time housing listings, search and filtering tools, map-based navigation, and in-app communication will be developed. Additional features like verified listings and transparent pricing will also be integrated. Continuous testing will be conducted during this stage. Outputs include a functional backend system, working mobile interface, integrated core features, and an initial (alpha) version of the application.

The project then moves into the Integration and Testing Phase (January–February 2027). This phase ensures that all components work smoothly together. Secure payment systems will be added, and the application will undergo rigorous testing under different conditions. Data protection measures will also be

implemented in compliance with the Data Privacy Act of 2012. Outputs include integrated payment system, bug fixes, security validation results, and a stable pre-beta version.

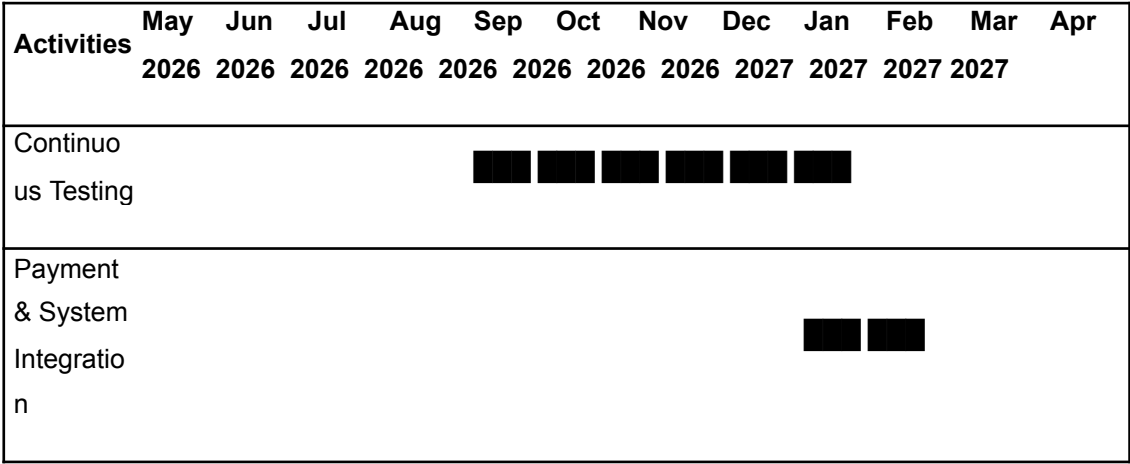
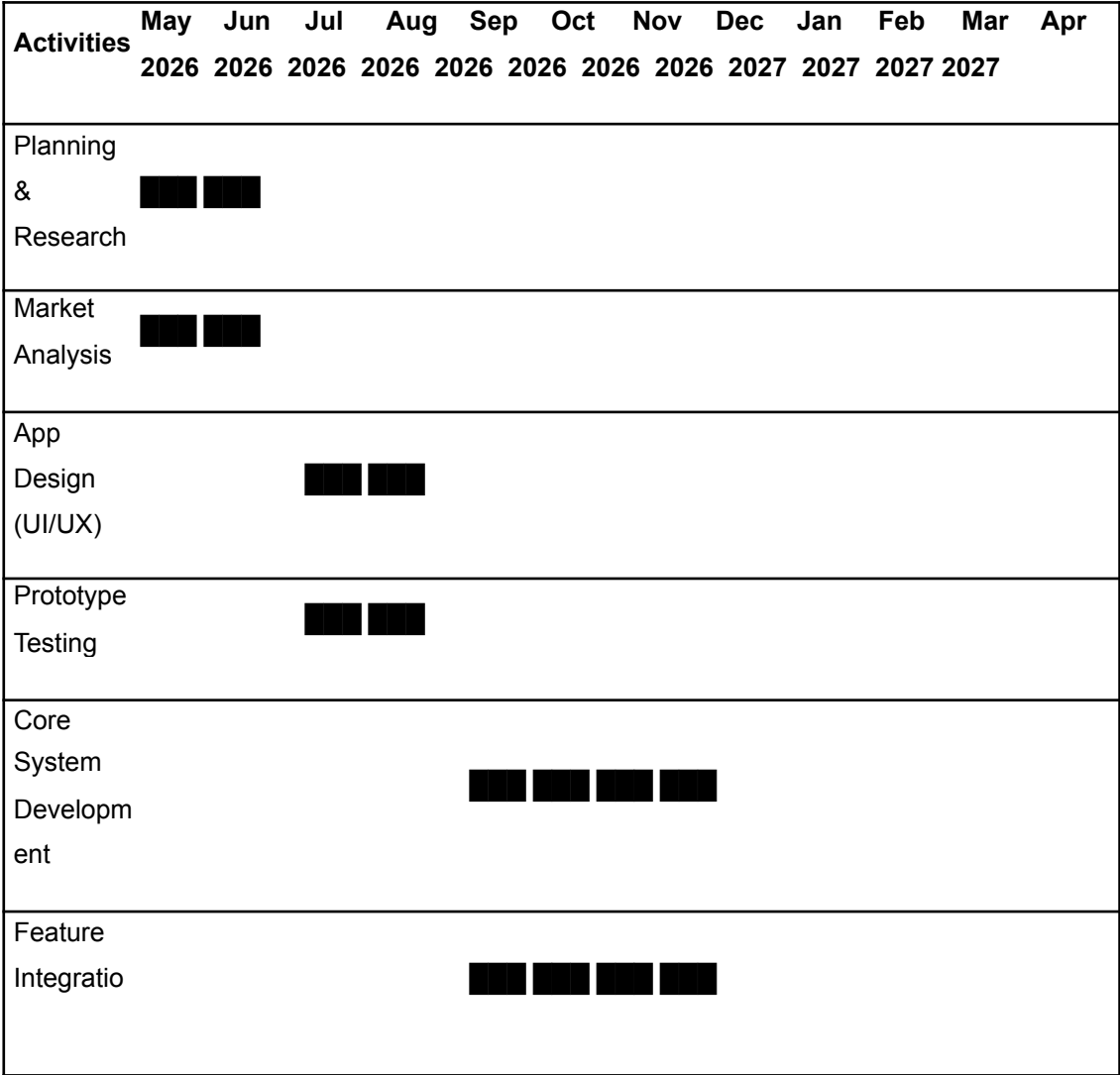
After this, the project enters the Beta Testing and Marketing Phase (March 2027). A beta version of the app will be released to selected users to gather final feedback. At the same time, marketing strategies such as social media promotions, referral campaigns, and partnerships will be executed to build awareness. Outputs include beta version release, user feedback reports, marketing materials, and improved system performance.

Finally, the project concludes with the Launch Preparation and Official Launch Phase (April 2027). Final system checks and refinements will be completed before making the application publicly available. Outputs include the deployment-ready application, launch strategy, live system release, initial user adoption, and post-launch monitoring plans.

Overall, this phased approach ensures that Zzzpace is developed in a logical and progressive manner, from research and design to development, testing, and deployment. By clearly defining outputs at each stage, the project minimizes risks, improves system quality, and ensures that the final product effectively addresses the housing challenges faced by students.

TIMELINE: GANTT CHART

This timeline presents an outline of the major phases in the application



Security Testing	■■■ ■■■
Beta Testing	■■■
Marketing & Promotions	■■■ ■■■
Launch Preparation	■■■ ■■■
Official Launch	■■■

VIII. OUR TEAM AND PARTNERS

Our partners will include local landlords and boarding house owners, who will play a vital role in providing accurate, verified, and up-to-date listings within the platform. Their participation ensures that students can access reliable housing information without the confusion of traditional social media postings. In addition, partnerships with Local Government Units (LGUs) help ensure that all listed properties comply with local housing regulations, safety standards, and business requirements, strengthening the credibility and trustworthiness of the platform.

Furthermore, Zzzpace considers collaboration with digital service providers such as GCash to support secure and convenient in-app payments, allowing users to complete transactions efficiently. Coordination with Central Mindanao University is also essential in promoting the platform within the student community and aligning services with student needs. These partnerships not only expand the platform's reach but also enhance its reliability, making Zzzpace a trusted and innovative housing marketplace for students



GCash



PayMaya



Local Government Unit

The success of Zzzpace will rely on strong collaboration among team members and partners who will support the platform's goal of improving the housing experience for Central Mindanao University students. The development team is composed of dedicated individuals who will work together through designing, planning, and developing the system that addresses the real challenges students face in finding affordable and reliable housing. Through collaboration, creativity, and shared responsibility, the team will ensure that Zzzpace is both practical and user-centered.



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IV. IX. REFERENCES

